

Ben Morris

Postdoctoral Fellow | Department of Psychology | Yale University
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Present Appointment

NSF Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Psychology
Yale University, Computational Social Cognition Lab (*PI*: Julian Jara-Ettinger)

Education

<i>PhD</i>	University of Chicago , Psychology <i>Advisor</i> : Alex Shaw	2024
<i>MA</i>	University of Chicago , Psychology <i>Advisors</i> : Alex Shaw & Daniel Yurovsky	2021
<i>MPhil</i>	University of Cambridge , King's College, Developmental Psychology Graduated with Academic Distinction <i>Advisor</i> : Claire Hughes	2016
<i>BA</i>	Reed College , Psychology Graduated Phi Beta Kappa <i>Advisor</i> : Jennifer Henderlong Corpus	2015

Honors &

Awards	National Science Foundation SBE Postdoctoral Fellowship (NSF SPRF)	2025-27
	Provost Dissertation Fellowship Award	2023-24
	Ruth Sosis Memorial Fellowship for Service	2023
	Dewey Lectureship Teaching Award	2023
	Norman H. Anderson Grant	2019, 2021, 2023
	Academic Distinction, University of Cambridge	2016
	Sperling Studentship, University of Cambridge	2015-16
	Phi Beta Kappa, Reed College	2015
	Opportunity Grant, Reed College	2015
	Initiative Grant in Undergraduate Research, Reed College	2015
	Commendation for Excellence for Academic Performance, Reed College	2011-15
	CSLI Summer Fellowship, Stanford University	2014
	ONPRC Summer Fellowship, Oregon Health and Science University	2013

Publications

<i>In prep</i>	Morris, B. , Wang, Z., & Jara-Ettinger, J. (in prep). Everyday Task Demands. Morris, B. , & Shaw, A. (in prep). "Oh! Um. . . Sure": Children and adults use other's linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes.
<i>Submitted or Under Review</i>	*Morris, B. , *Suwal, U., Lin, Q., Rubio-Fernandez, R., & Jara-Ettinger, J. (submitted). Speakers strategically adjust their image descriptions based on perceived memorability. <i>Journal of Experimental Psychology: General</i> . *Bergey, C. , *Morris, B. , & Yurovsky, D. (invited revision). Language selectively encodes atypical features of the world. <i>Nature Communications</i> .

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- Published* *Hok, H., ***Morris, B.**, & Shaw, A. (under review). Fair Rules, Unfair Use: Children negatively evaluate inconsistent rule use. *Psych Science*.
- Morris, B.** & Jara-Ettinger, J. (2026). Epistemic Extrapolation: Inferring the Fine-Grained Structure of Others' Knowledge From Minimal Evidence. In *Proceedings of the 48th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- Morris, B.** & Jara-Ettinger, J. (2026). How Long *Should* That Take? Reading Minds in Real Time from Decision Speed. In *Proceedings of the 48th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- Morris, B.**, Shaw, A., & Liberman, Z. (2026). Calibrated deference: Children's evaluations of responses to disagreement across knowledge gaps. *Cognition*.
- Morris, B.**, Yurovsky, D., & Shaw, A. (2026). "Um..." Thinking out loud: Children infer social meaning from speech disfluencies. *Child Development*.
- *Suwal, U., ***Morris, B.**, Lin, Q., Rubio-Fernandez, R., & Jara-Ettinger, J. (2025). Speakers strategically adjust their descriptions based on perceived memorability. In *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- Morris, B.**, & Shaw, A. (2024). "Oh! Um. . . Sure": Children and adults use other's linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes. In *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- *Leung, A.C., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2021). Children know what words other children know. In *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- *Bergey, C.A., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2020). Children hear more about what is atypical than what is typical. In *Proceedings of the 42nd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- ManyBabies Consortium (2020). Quantifying sources of variability in infancy research using the infant-directed speech preference. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*.
- Morris, B.** & Yurovsky, D. (2019). Pressure to communicate across knowledge asymmetries leads to pedagogically supportive language input. In *Proceedings of the 41st Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Invited

Presentations

Developmental Brown Bag, Brown University	2026
Developmental Speaker Series, New York University	2025
Social Learning Lab, Stanford University	2023
Language And Cognition Lab, Stanford University	2023
Department of Comparative Cultural Psychology, Max Planck Institute	2023
Computational Social Cognition Lab, Yale University	2022
Developmental Brown Bag, University of Wisconsin, Madison	2021
Markman Lab, Stanford University	2021

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Teaching	Infant Communication (UChicago, Instructor of Record)	2024
Teaching	Human Language and Interaction (UChicago, Marisa Casillas)	2023
Assistant	Introduction to Developmental Psychology (UChicago, Kate O'Doherty)	2022
	Development of Social Cognition (UChicago, Katherine Kinzler)	2022
	Introduction to Developmental Psychology (UChicago, Kate O'Doherty)	2022
	Development of Social Cognition (UChicago, Katherine Kinzler)	2021
	Developmental Psychology (Reed College, Jennifer Henderlong Corpus)	2015
	Research Design and Data Analysis (Reed College, Kathryn Oleson)	2015
	Research Design and Data Analysis (Reed College, Kathryn Oleson)	2014
<i>Guest Lecturer</i>	Human Language and Interaction	2023
	The Psychology of Communication (Summer course for highschoolers)	2022, 2023
<i>Pedagogical Development</i>	Inclusive Teaching in Psychology (Workshop, Yale)	
	Equitable Teaching in the Social Sciences and Humanities (10 wk course, Yale)	
	CCTE 50000: Course Design and College Teaching (Semester Course, UChicago)	
	Individual Teaching Observation and Consultation (UChicago)	
	Teaching in the Age of AI (Workshop, UChicago)	
	Inclusive Teaching: Belonging, Structure, and Active Learning (UChicago)	
	Gamification for Higher Education (Workshop, UChicago)	
	Fundamentals of Teaching (4 wk course, UChicago)	
Service	Diversity & Inclusion Committee , University of Chicago	2021- 2024
	Travel & Research Committee , University of Chicago	2018-2024
	Student Peer Mentor , University of Chicago	2019-2024
	President - Psychology Grad Student Organization , UChicago	2021-2022
	Graduate Cross-Talks Co-Organizer , University of Chicago	2021- 2022
	ReproducibiliTea Co-Founder and Organizer , University of Chicago.	2020- 2022
	Graduate Society Social Secretary , University of Cambridge	2015-2016
	Teaching Consultant , Reed College, Genetics and Genomics (Sarah Schaack)	2015
	Head Student Teacher , Portland Public Schools	2011-2015
	Teaching Consultant , Reed College, Ethnomusicology (Morgan Luker)	2014
	Student Teacher , Helen Gordon Child Development Center	2013-2014
	Student Judicial Board Member , Reed College	2013-2015
	Peer Tutor , Reed College, various courses	2012-2015
Mentorship	Matias Martin, SURF Summer Research Assistant (Yale University)	Summer 2026
	Julia Miller, Undergraduate Research Assistant (Yale University)	2025-2026
	Kate Choi, Summer Research Assistant (Yale University)	Summer 2025
	Sophie Lau, Undergraduate Honors Thesis (Yale University)	2024-2025
	Sooyoun Zong, Masters Thesis Student (University of Chicago)	2023-2024
	Emma Tung, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	2023-2024
	Yibo Pan, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	2020-2023
	Cassie Wilson, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	2020-2022
	Madison Collins, Summer Research Assistant (University of Chicago)	Summer 2020

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Abbie Klein, Undergraduate Honors Thesis (University of Chicago) 2019-2020
Madeline Meyers, Undergraduate Research Assistant (University of Chicago) 2017-18
Emmi Russo, Undergraduate Honors Thesis (University of Chicago) 2016-17

Conference Presentations

- Morris, B. & Shaw, A.** (2025, April). Oh! Um. . . Sure”: Children and adults use other’s linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes. Talk presented at the Society for Research on Child Development, Minneapolis, MN.
- Morris, B. & Shaw, A.** (2024, July). Oh! Um. . . Sure”: Children and adults use other’s linguistic surprisal to reason about expectations and learn stereotypes. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting, Rotterdam, NL.
- *Leung, A.C., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2022, January). Children know what words other children know. Talk presented at the Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development, Online.
- *Leung, A.C., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2021, July). Children know what words other children know. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting, Online.
- Morris, B. & Shaw, A.** (2021, June). “Umm”: When children do and do not use speech disfluencies to infer knowledge. Talk presented at the Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Online.
- *Bergey, C.A., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2021, April). Children hear more about what is atypical than what is typical. Talk presented at the Society for Research on Child Development Biannual Meeting, Online.
- Morris, B.**, Yurovsky, D. & Shaw, A. (2021, April). Children use speech disfluencies to make social inferences. Talk presented at the Society for Research on Child Development Biannual Meeting, Online.
- *Bergey, C.A., ***Morris, B.**, & Yurovsky, D. (2020, July). Children hear more about what is atypical than what is typical. Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Online.
- Morris, B.**, Appleby, E., Shadrach, L., Troxell-Whitman, Z., & Corpus, J.H. (2015, February). Gender dynamics in parent-to-child and child-to-parent attention-seeking behaviors. Talk presented at the annual meeting of the Oregon Academy of Science, Psychology section, Portland, OR.

Poster Presentations

- Morris, B.**, & Jara-Ettinger, J. (2026, March). Epistemic Extrapolation: Inferring the Fine-Grained Structure of Others’ Knowledge From Minimal Evidence. Poster to be presented at the Cognitive Science Society, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
- Morris, B.**, & Jara-Ettinger, J. (2026, March).). How Long *Should* That Take? Reading Minds in Real Time from Decision Speed. Poster to be presented at the Cognitive Science Society, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

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- Morris, B., & Jara-Ettinger, J.** (2026, March). "What else do you know?": Inferring knowledge structure from sparse observation. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, Canada.
- *Kim, E., ***Morris, B., & Shaw, A.** (2026, March). Children's evaluations of listeners from speakers' explanations. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, Canada.
- Morris, B., & Shaw, A.** (2024, March). "Umbrellas keep you dry": Children use listener design to infer others' knowledge. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society, Pasadena, CA.
- Morris, B., & Shaw, A.** (2023, March). "Umbrellas keep you dry": Children use listener design to infer others' knowledge. Poster presented at the Society for Research on Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.
- Morris, B., Yurovsky, D., & Shaw, A.** (2022, April). The many meanings of "um": Children interpret disfluencies differently across contexts. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Madison, WI.
- Morris, B. & Shaw, A.** (2020, January). "Umm": When children do and do not use speech disfluencies to infer knowledge. Poster presented at the Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary.
- Morris, B., Bergey, C.A., & Yurovsky, D.** (2019, October). Child language input does not reflect world frequency: Typical and atypical feature description across development. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Meeting, Louisville, KY.
- Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D.** (2019, July). Pressure to communicate across knowledge asymmetries leads to pedagogically supportive language input. Poster presented at the 41st Cognitive Science Society Meeting, Montreal, Canada.
- Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D.** (2018, July). Planning and communicative pressure leads to language input that supports learning. Poster presented at the 40th Cognitive Science Society Conference, Madison, WI.
- Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D.** (2018, May). Modeling the effect of communicative pressure on language input. Poster presented at the Midwest Cognitive Science Conference, Bloomington, IN.
- Morris, B. & Yurovsky, D.** (2017, October). Communicative pressure can lead to language input that supports learning. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference, Portland, OR.
- Morris, B. & Corpus, J.H.** (2016, April). Preschool children's learning and motivation in game-based learning contexts. Poster presented at the American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.

*Both authors contributed equally.

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Prior Research Experience

Communication and Learning Lab, PI: Daniel Yurovsky *2016-2018*
University of Chicago, Lab Manager

Centre for Family Research, PI: Claire Hughes *2015-2016*
University of Cambridge, Master's Student and Research Assistant

Children's Motivation Project, PI: Jennifer Henderlong Corpus *2013-2015*
Reed College, Undergraduate Thesis Student and Research Assistant

Language and Cognition Lab, PI: Michael C. Frank *Summer 2014*
Stanford University, CSLI Summer Intern (advised by Molly Lewis)

Oregon National Primate Research Center, PI: Christa Helms *Summer 2013*
Oregon Health and Science University, Summer Intern

Adolescent Health Research Program, PI: Kristen Anderson *2012-2013*
Reed College, Research Assistant